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MAY 2025

GAZETTE

Hollywood & Westwood



LET'S 'SHELLEBRATE' WORLD TURTLE DAY!

Do you know the difference between a turtle and a tortoise? We usually say that a tortoise is a kind of turtle, but not all turtles are tortoises. Tortoises are exclusively land animals, unlike turtles which live in the water most of the time. Due to this difference, aquatic turtles usually have flippers or webbed toes, while tortoises have pillar-like hind legs that have evolved for walking on land. One other thing that distinguishes tortoises is their diet. Turtles are generally omnivores - they eat both plants and animals. Tortoises, on the other hand, are mostly vegetarians.

It is estimated that 61 percent of turtle species are already extinct. Biologists and other experts predict the disappearance of turtles and tortoises in the wild within the next 50 years. These gentle animals have been around for 260 million years, yet they are rapidly disappearing as a result of smuggling, the exotic food industry, habitat destruction, global warming, and a cruel pet trade.

It's clear that there is an urgent reason to bring attention to the turtles of the world. The good news is that there is an occasion just right for this purpose. In honor of these fascinating creatures, World Turtle Day was launched in the year 2000 by the nonprofit organization American Tortoise Rescue. This day is celebrated annually on May 23rd and it was created to increase respect and knowledge of one of the world's oldest creatures. World Turtle Day also helps people celebrate and protect turtles and tortoises and their disappearing habitats around the world.

Let's "shellebrate" the existence of these beautiful creatures together, and make sure they are safe and happy with us, even in the future!

Source of Reference
"Demystified | Turtles vs. Tortoises", Britannica, Oct 3, 2024
American Tortoise Rescue
World Turtle Day

By Yeojin



HEADLINE: GOLDEN WEEK IN JAPAN

In Japan, the longest holiday of the year is in May called Golden Week. This is because it starts with the birthday of Emperor Showa, followed by Constitution Memorial Day, Children's Day, and Greenery Day - in that order.

Not all of these holidays come one right after the other. For example, if one holiday falls on a Tuesday and the next falls on a Thursday, we make that Wednesday a holiday as well. If a holiday falls on a Saturday or Sunday, we move it to Monday. Thus, it often becomes a 10 consecutive day holiday every year!

Many Japanese people look forward to Golden Week, but it is basically only for people who work in offices. For people who work in restaurants and retail stores, it is the same as usual as the stores are still open during the holiday.

Since it is a long holiday, if you try to travel abroad during Golden Week, travel expenses will be more than three times higher than usual - so in reality it is not easy to travel abroad during this time. However, Golden Week is the best time to visit Tokyo. Since many people travel domestically or leave Tokyo to go back home, Tokyo is not crowded at this time of year. There are no traffic jams and it is a very pleasant and relaxing place. Also, all of the restaurants and tourist facilities in Tokyo are still open.

Finally, Golden Week is the best time to visit Tokyo because the weather is the best at this time of the year - the humidity is low and there is little rain. This period is truly the "Golden Week" in the sense that the normally busy, noisy city of Tokyo is laid back!!

By Masako

A HIDDEN GEM IN SOUTH KOREA



When people think of traveling to South Korea, they often think of Seoul and Busan. However, Daejeon – a city blending nature, relaxation, and delicious food – is an underrated destination worth exploring!

One of Daejeon's must-visit spots is the Yuseong Hot Springs, a natural thermal pool known for its healing properties. Visitors can enjoy a free foot bath in the public area or relax in one of the many nearby spas. Another great place to visit is the Hanbat Arboretum, the largest urban botanical garden in Korea. It offers scenic walking trails, themed gardens, and a peaceful atmosphere - perfect for nature lovers.



Food aficionados will also find Daejeon delightful. Sungsimdang, a legendary local bakery, is famous for its strawberry siru cake, a soft cake layered with fresh strawberries and cream. Additionally, Daejeon is known for its delicious kalguksu (knife-cut noodles). Many local restaurants serve this comforting dish with rich broth and handmade noodles, making it a must-try meal!

With its relaxing hot springs, beautiful nature, and amazing food, Daejeon is a perfect destination for travelers looking for a unique experience in Korea. If you want to discover a different side of the country, make sure to add Daejeon to your itinerary!

By Jeongui

THINGS EVERYONE SHOULD EXPERIENCE IN ITALY AT LEAST ONCE

Italy is a country that leaves its mark. Some experiences go beyond simply visiting a museum or writing a postcard; some experiences make you feel like a part of the culture. Here a few things that, in my opinion, can help you truly feel the essence of Italy:

Getting lost in the streets of a small village (or borgo) is one of the best ways to discover Italy's hidden gems.

Having breakfast at a coffee bar with a cornetto and cappuccino is the most Italian way to start your day.

Visiting local markets allows you to discover the culinary soul of a city. Chatting with vendors and tasting local food helps you connect with the real Italian vibe.

Enjoy an aperitivo with a view. The aperitivo is an institution in Italy. I suggest a glass of good wine at sunset – by the sea or in a historic square.

Have dinner in an Italian family's home, because sharing a meal with the family in Italy is not only about eating - it's also about sharing stories and emotions.

Sit in a piazza and watch the slow life. A piazza is not only a square, it is a place full of life. Spend time there enjoying the slow living and observe the locals.

Italy is not just a destination, it is an experience!

By Selena









THE JEONJU INTERNATIONAL FILM FESTIVAL IN MAY – A "MUST VISIT" EVENT IN KOREA

Are you a cinephile? Then don't miss this event in May in Korea!

The Jeonju International Film Festival (JIFF) is one of the Big Three film festivals in Korea, along with Busan and Bucheon. Held in Jeonju every spring, it'll be from May 1st to 10th this year. The Jeonju International Film Festival continues to inspire and expand the boundaries of cinema, making it a must-visit event for film lovers worldwide. It's known for its focus on independent, experimental, and alternative cinema.

Since its founding in 2000, JIFF has provided a platform for emerging filmmakers and storytelling from around the world. There is also a signature program, called the Jeonju Cinema Project, which funds and produces unique films, further solidifying its role in supporting creative voices.

So you can experience lots of creative films and talk with passionate people in the field of films. Along with the Jeonju International Film Festival, the city of Jeonju is a great place to visit as it's the most delicious city in Korea! For example, Bibimbop originated in Jeonju. Jeonju's historical significance has even been recognized by UNESCO, leading to the creation of a special UNESCO travel course in the city.

I hope you take the opportunity to experience both the festival and the rich cultural heritage of Jeonju!

By Julie

WORLD SMILE DAY

World Smile Day is celebrated on the first Friday of May every year. I will introduce the origin and purpose of the event, and ways to celebrate this day.

As for the origin, World Smile Day was created by an American cartoonist named Harvey Ball in 1999. He created the “smiley face” drawing in the 1960s, symbolizing positive emotions and kindness. He valued smiling a lot, so he created the day to remind people of the importance of smiling and to encourage positive actions.

The main purpose of World Smile Day is to remind people of the power of a smile and to encourage positive effects between each other. The day promotes kind actions and offers an opportunity to strengthen the sense of community.

Ways to celebrate World Smile Day include various activities such as smile challenges in schools or communities, volunteering, or participating in campaigns that promote the importance of smiles.

It’s amazing that such an important day in May promotes positive connections between people and creates a happy atmosphere all over the world! Let’s all smile brightly and have a happy May together!



By Bella